PREFACE

PHP is an open source, server-side, HTML embedded scripting language used to create dynamic web pages. However, there are many languages which are used for web development or web programming. But among all of them PHP is the most popular web scripting language. So, let us find out why PHP is widely used for web development. PHP language has its roots in C and C++. PHP syntax is most similar to C and C++ language syntax. So, programmers find it easy to learn and manipulate.

Organization of the Book

The 2nd edition of this book is comprised of nine chapters. The book includes basic through advanced functionality, this book explains how to develop dynamic Web applications, such as guest books, chat rooms, and shopping carts.

Chapter 1 covers essential background on the PHP language. It describes the nature and history of PHP, which platforms it runs on, and how to configure it. This chapter ends by showing you PHP in action, with a quick walkthrough of several PHP programs that illustrate common tasks, such as processing form data, interacting with a database, and creating graphics.

Chapter 2 shows you the data types, the PHP operators, the flow-control statements. PHP allows eight different types of data types. All of them are discussed in this chapter.

Chapter 3 discusses the functions in PHP and explains the CPU usage information. Functions are useful because they contribute to rapid, reliable, error-reducing coding, and increase legibility by tiding up complicated code sequences. A focus on serialization is given.